



CGI



CGI expects to read from stdin until EOF.

Chunked encoding breaks this because the body is scattered across chunks.

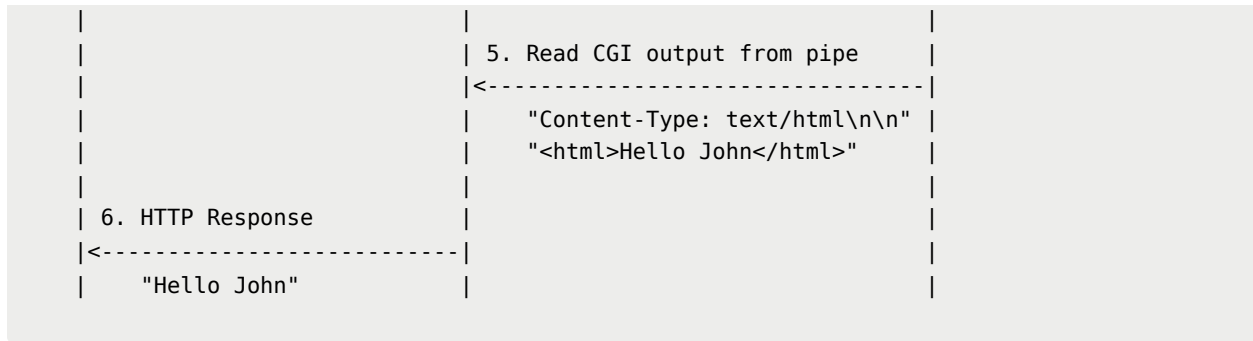
1. Read all chunks until "0\r\n\r\n"
2. Reassemble them into a complete body
3. Write the unchunked body to CGI's stdin
4. Close the pipe (send EOF)

Chunked input: "4\r\nWiki\r\n5\r\npedia\r\n0\r\n\r\n"

Unchunked body: "Wikipedia"

Write to CGI: Wikipedia (then close pipe)





Common Gateway Interface (CGI) is a standard protocol that allows web servers to execute external programs and generate dynamic content.

When a web browser requests a dynamic resource (like a .php file or a Python script), the web server launches an external program, passes the request information to it, and sends the program's output back to the web browser.

Analogy

The Web Server is a restaurant host. CGI is like the kitchen. The host takes your order (HTTP request), hands the ticket to the kitchen (CGI), the kitchen cooks (program executes), and the host brings you the food (HTTP response).

Why CGI Exists

Without CGI, Web Servers could only serve static files (HTML, CSS, images). With CGI, they can:

- Generate dynamic pages based on user input
- Process form submissions
- Access databases
- Run any programming language